A-A-2361
July 22,1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHALK, LINE MARKING, POWDER and CHALK, MARKING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Interim Federal Specification SS-C-00255

This commercial item description covers two types of chalk.

Type I - Chalk,line marking, powder (carpenters' chalk)
Type II - Chalk, marking (railroad chalk)

The type I chalk, line marking, commonly known as carpenters' chalk, is intended for use in construction work for the purpose of transferring a chalk line from a length of string to the work.

The type II chalk, marking, commonly known as railroad chalk, is intended for the purpose of making identification marks on wood, metal, stone, and concrete.

Salient characteristics.

The chalk shall contain not less than 60 percent by weight calcium sulfate ($CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$) when tested in accordance with the test procedure in ASTM C 471, Chemical Analysis of Gypsum and Gypsum Products.

The type I chalk shall weigh no less than 7 pounds per gross. The chalk shall be hemispherical in shape, shall have a base diameter of not less than 2 inches, and shall be not less than 3/4 inch in height.

The type II chalk shall weigh no less than 8 pounds per gross. The chalk shall be conical in shape, shall be not less than 3-3/4 inches long, and tapered with the smaller end rounded. When specified in the contract or purchase order, the chalk shall be uniformly coated with a suitable enamel for cleanliness in handling.

The color of the chalk shall be white, blue, red, or yellow. The color shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Workmanship. The chalk shall have a smooth, uniform surface and shall be free from holes, cracks, ripples, lumps, excessive dust, discoloration, foreign matter, or any defects which may cause undesirable effects during use.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with the Section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

FSC 7510

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Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or purchase order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the CID where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Inspection of the end item. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. The inspection level shall be S-2, with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The lot size shall consist of all packages containing one type and color of chalk offered for acceptance at one time. The sample unit shall be one package.

Composition test. Sample pieces of chalk shall be subjected to the applicable test procedure in ASTM C 471 to determine the amount of calcium sulfate present in the chalk. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection level S-2, with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The lot size shall be all packages containing one type and color of chalk offered for acceptance at one time. The sample unit shall be one package. The composition test shall be required at the beginning of each contract and the results kept on file by the manufacturer for the duration of the contract.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Notes. Purchaser must specify type, color, and if type II whether a coating is required.

Copies of ASTM standards may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

Copies of military standards may be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

WHEN THIS COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION IS USED FOR PROCUREMENT, THE COMMERCIAL ITEM CERTIFICATION CLAUSE DOES NOT NEED TO APPEAR IN THE SOLICITATION.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

None.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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